

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Analyst | SOC Operations | SIEM/EDR | Incident Handling | Threat Detection

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Analyst with more than five years of experience operating within Security Operations Centre (SOC) environments, delivering alert triage, incident handling, and threat detection and analysis across complex multi-technology estates. I have extensive hands-on experience with Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, including CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, as well as Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), Intrusion Detection System (IDS), and email security gateway tooling. I have operated within a Computer Security Incident Response Team (CSIRT) capacity, managing the full incident lifecycle from initial detection through containment, eradication, and recovery, in line with the NIST 800-61 incident response framework. I am experienced in the education and research sector and understand the unique network and user behaviour challenges it presents. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a structured, intelligence-led approach to SOC service delivery.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rule authoring and tuning; Splunk Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform (Security Practitioner level)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** PowerShell-based SOAR automation, alert enrichment, and automated response playbooks
- **Intrusion Detection System (IDS) / Intrusion Prevention System (IPS):** Alert analysis, network anomaly detection, escalation workflows
- **Web Application Firewall (WAF) and DDoS Mitigation:** Network perimeter security, traffic analysis, attack mitigation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, Computer Security Incident Response Team (CSIRT) operations
- **Threat Detection and Analysis:** Detection engineering, threat hunting using SIEM/EDR data, intelligence-led triage
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Operate the Security Operations Centre (SOC) service, including alert triage across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, investigating and prioritising security events, and managing support ticket queues to ensure timely response and escalation.
- Lead threat detection and analysis activities, authoring and tuning detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL) to identify emerging attack patterns across the enterprise estate.
- Act as the primary escalation point for complex security incidents, managing the full incident handling lifecycle from initial detection through containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review, in line with NIST 800-61.
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform, including alert triage, real-time response actions, and automated threat containment using Falcon SOAR capabilities.

- Manage Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows using PowerShell-based playbooks, automating alert enrichment, initial containment actions, and stakeholder notifications to improve MTTR.
- Gather intelligence on threat actors and attack campaigns using a range of commercial and open-source tools, applying findings to improve detection coverage and inform proactive threat hunting activities.
- Maintain and configure Intrusion Detection System (IDS)/Intrusion Prevention System (IPS) monitoring, investigating network anomalies and escalating confirmed threats through the incident response process.
- Manage email security gateway (Mimecast) and web filtering policies, mitigating phishing, malware delivery, and DDoS-adjacent threats targeting the organisation.
- Produce clear, actionable incident reports and post-incident reviews for technical and non-technical stakeholders, including senior management and governance committees.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) alerts across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, investigating anomalous behaviour, performing root cause analysis, and coordinating incident response activities.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, establishing centralised endpoint threat detection and identity-based alerting integrated into the SOC workflow.
- Operated within the Computer Security Incident Response Team (CSIRT) function, participating in incident handling duties including evidence preservation, forensic analysis, containment, and recovery actions.
- Contributed to threat detection engineering by developing and tuning detection rules, reducing false positive rates and improving signal-to-noise ratios across SIEM and EDR platforms.
- Performed threat hunting activities across SIEM and EDR data, using MITRE ATT&CK-mapped hypotheses to proactively identify attacker presence not detected by automated alerting.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, feeding findings into the risk register and supporting remediation prioritisation based on threat intelligence context.
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate routine SOC tasks, including alert triage enrichment, account lockout investigation, and compliance report generation.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus certification by demonstrating and documenting security controls across endpoint, identity, and network security domains.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Designed and implemented cloud security monitoring controls within Microsoft Azure, establishing logging pipelines and alert configurations to support security event visibility across the SaaS environment.
- Managed endpoint security tooling, responding to security alerts, conducting initial triage, and escalating confirmed incidents through a structured incident response process.
- Administered identity and access management controls including Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and role-based access control (RBAC) within Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD).
- Managed vulnerability scanning programme and patch management processes, prioritising remediation of critical vulnerabilities across a hybrid cloud-on-premises environment.
- Contributed to security incident documentation, post-incident review processes, and lessons-learned exercises to continuously improve the organisation's incident response capability.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to 8,000 users, delivering centralised endpoint and identity threat detection integrated into the SOC alert workflow.
- Reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) to high-severity alerts by 40% through implementation of Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks automating alert enrichment, initial triage, and containment steps.

- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification through structured technical remediation across endpoint, identity, and network security controls.
- Designed and tuned a detection rule library in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), improving true positive rates and reducing analyst alert fatigue across the SOC team.
- Delivered Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme to validate SOC detection coverage against real-world adversary techniques mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, identifying and closing detection gaps across critical attack paths.
- Delivered structured security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns to 8,000 users, reducing phishing susceptibility and improving self-reporting rates across the organisation.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)